

When to speak and how?

NPTEL

*MOOC
Soft skills
development*

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Overview

- Quiz
- Introduction
- Voice skills
- From listening to speaking
- Strategic speaking
- Speaking in groups
- Examples
- References

Are you a good speaker?

- Survey : **Are you a good public speaker?** (*The Managers Guide*)
<http://www.themanagersguide.co.uk/quizgoodpublicspeaker.html>

Please enter your self-assessment scores in the **Discussion Forum** Link provided so that we can know what is the general level of speaking skills of this class.

The relevance of listening

Before you speak:

- Make eye contact
- Non-verbal gestures and expressions
- Avoid showing signs that you are distracted
- Ask questions
- Paraphrase or clarify
- Make a smooth transition from listening to speaking

From listening to speaking

- Listen for conversation control – seek first to understand and then to be understood
- Unsolicited advice – what not to speak
- My story vs. her story – when and if to shift focus
- The “I” habit – talking about ourselves
- Questions – specific and clarifying

Speaking in formal groups

- Listen first
- Seek openings – physical and conceptual
- Wait for pauses and breaks
- Use non-verbal gestures – to intervene and then to continue
- Assertion vs. aggression
- When in Rome act like Romans

Gender in listening and speaking

- Men focus on status, try to dominate – women attempt to create connections
- Women often feel men are not listening – they tend try to give solutions, while women often want to build up relation
- Understanding – symmetrical; advice – asymmetrical
- Women often use 'sorry' in an empathetic sense, which can be misunderstood by men

But these are culture specific: activity

- Let us find out:
- Activity in Group Discussion Forum – check it out
- In the survey provided there, ***share what you think about the positive and negative traits of speaking and listening of the opposite sex***
- Based on your feedback, we will find out what is the common perception in the Indian context

Voice advice

- The voice conveys a lot about
- Emotions: anger, fear, sadness, happiness...
- Attitude: aggression, submission, passion
- Personality: positive, negative, optimistic, pessimistic
- *How do we make sense of voice*

Can we change our ways of speaking?

- Yes, we can
- Check the Discussion Forum
- Check the PDFs that we share

Voice and Speaking Skills for Dummies: Judy Apps

Effective voice: quiz

- Pleasant
- Balanced
- Relaxed
- Clear
- Expressive

– *Let us find out what you think*

How we perceive voices

Simulated voice	speaker	General perception
Breathiness	Male	Young, more artistic
	Female	Feminine, pretty, petit, high strung, shallow
Tenseness	Male	Older, resistant, quarrelsome
	Female	Younger, more emotional, high-strung, less intelligent
Rotundity	Male	More energetic, healthy, interesting, enthusiastic
	Female	Increased liveliness, talkative, proud
Increased pitch variety	Male	More energetic, dynamic
	Female	More dynamic, feminine

Survey to check it out

Check the **discussion forum** for the link:

You will be asked to listen to different voices and find out what they convey to you.

It will be your collaborative decision as to what voice conveys
We will share the results with you in a week

References

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